Standalone Action Worksheet 01: The 7-Day Time & Revenue Leak Audit

Companion Workbook Edition: *The AI Freelancer Operating System* (Tier 0 Free Lead Magnet & Tiers 2–3 Interactive Workbook Suite)
Format Compatibility: Print (`US Letter 8.5" x 11"` / `ISO A4`), Interactive AcroForm PDF, and Hyperlinked Tablet Digital Planner (`GoodNotes / Notability / reMarkable`)
Paired Manuscript Chapter: Chapter 1 — *The Overwhelmed Freelancer's Bottleneck (The 5-Stage Operating Model)*

Instructions for Execution

Use this standalone five-part worksheet to establish your baseline operational metrics during Week 1 and lock in your daily execution habits. If you are using the **Complete Operating System (`Tier 3`)** or the **Free Lead Magnet (`Tier 0`)**, you can also enter your **Part A** numbers directly into **Module 1 (Interactive EHR Leak Calculator)** inside `freelancer-os-app.html` for instant visual calculation and PDF export.

- **Audit Period Start Date:** `____ / ____ / 2026`
- **Audit Period End Date:** `____ / ____ / 2026`
- **Practitioner Name / Studio:** `_____`
- **Primary Service Niche:** `_____`

Part A: EHR Diagnostic (Baseline Effective Hourly Rate & Leak Calculator)

Step A1: 7-Day Raw Time Bucket Log (In 0.5-Hour Increments)

Track every working hour across seven consecutive days into the four strict operational buckets: * **Bucket A (Core Billable Craft):** Direct high-skill execution on signed, in-scope client deliverables. * **Bucket B (Unbilled Client Friction):** Unscoped revisions, Slack/email hand-holding, chasing missing logins/files. * **Bucket C (Sales & Proposal Overhead):** Discovery calls, custom proposal writing, lead follow-ups. * **Bucket D (Internal Admin Debt):** Invoicing, bookkeeping, folder organization, context-switching recovery.

Day of Week	Bucket A Hours *(Billable Craft)*	Bucket B Hours *(Unbilled Friction)*	Bucket C Hours *(Sales & Proposals)*	Bucket D Hours *(Internal Admin)*	Daily Total Hours *(A + B + C + D)*	Primary Friction Note / Leak Observed
Monday	`____ hrs`	`____ hrs`	`____ hrs`	`____ hrs`	`____ hrs`	`_____`
Tuesday	`____ hrs`	`____ hrs`	`____ hrs`	`____ hrs`	`____ hrs`	`_____`
Wednesday	`____ hrs`	`____ hrs`	`____ hrs`	`____ hrs`	`____ hrs`	`_____`
Thursday	`____ hrs`	`____ hrs`	`____ hrs`	`____ hrs`	`____ hrs`	`_____`
Friday	`____ hrs`	`____ hrs`	`____ hrs`	`____ hrs`	`____ hrs`	`_____`
Saturday	`____ hrs`	`____ hrs`	`____ hrs`	`____ hrs`	`____ hrs`	`_____`

Day of Week	Bucket A Hours *(Billable Craft)*	Bucket B Hours *(Unbilled Friction)*	Bucket C Hours *(Sales & Proposals)*	Bucket D Hours *(Internal Admin)*	Daily Total Hours *(A + B + C + D)*	Primary Friction Note / Leak Observed
Sunday	`____ hrs`	`____ hrs`	`____ hrs`	`____ hrs`	`____ hrs`	`_____`
7-DAY TOTAL	**`____ hrs`** *(Line C1)*	**`____ hrs`** *(Line C2)*	**`____ hrs`** *(Line C3)*	**`____ hrs`** *(Line C4)*	**`____ hrs`** *(Line D)*	**Feed Totals into Prompt 1.1**

Step A2: Baseline Effective Hourly Rate (EHR) Calculation Table (Lines A–H)

Line ID	Financial & Operational Metric	Exact Formula / Input Rule	Benchmark Target	Your Audited Value
Line A	**Gross Weekly Revenue Billed (USD)**	`Monthly Gross Revenue ÷ 4.0 Weeks`	`$1,000–$2,500+`	`$_____`
Line B	**Nominal Target Hourly Rate (USD)**	`Your quoted hourly or package baseline rate`	`$60.00–$125.00/hr`	`$_____ / hr`
Line C1	**Bucket A: Core Billable Craft Hours**	`7-Day Total from Column A above`	`>= 65% of Line D`	`_____ hrs`
Line C2	**Bucket B: Unbilled Client Friction Hours**	`7-Day Total from Column B above`	`<= 5% of Line D`	`_____ hrs`
Line C3	**Bucket C: Sales & Proposal Hours**	`7-Day Total from Column C above`	`<= 15% of Line D`	`_____ hrs`
Line C4	**Bucket D: Internal Admin Debt Hours**	`7-Day Total from Column D above`	`<= 15% of Line D`	`_____ hrs`
Line D	**Total Real Working Hours per Week**	`Line C1 + Line C2 + Line C3 + Line C4`	`<= 38.0 hrs/wk`	`_____ hrs`
Line E	**Billable Craft Utilization Ratio (%)**	`(Line C1 ÷ Line D) × 100`	`>= 65.0%`	`_____ %`
Line F	**Actual Effective Hourly Rate (EHR)**	**`Line A ÷ Line D`**	**`>= 80% of Line B`**	**`$_____ / hr`**
Line G	**Hourly Rate Erosion Gap (USD/hr)**	`Line B - Line F`	`< $12.00 / hr`	`-$_____ / hr`
Line H	**Monthly Unbilled Client Friction Loss**	`Line C2 × Line B × 4.0 Weeks`	`$0.00 / month`	**`$_____ / mo`**

Part B: 5-Stage Scorecard (Client Lifecycle Bottleneck Audit)

Score each of the five operational circuit-breaker gates from `1` **(No Gate / Reactive Chaos)** to `5` **(Systematized & Enforced Gate)**:

Stage Gate	Operational Gate Standard	Self-Audit Score (`1-5`)	Specific Evidence / Current Gap in Your Business	Target Fix Chapter
Stage 01: Input Gate *(Attract & Lead Triage)*	My services are packaged into 3 clear tiers, leads pass a pre-call red-flag filter, and proposals take `<= 15 mins`.	`[ 1 ] [ 2 ] [ 3 ] [ 4 ] [ 5 ]`	_____	**Chapters 2 & 3**
Stage 02: Commercial Gate *(Scope & Margin Defense)*	Every quote uses the `B.C.R.` formula, includes explicit exclusion clauses, and requires a `50%` upfront deposit.	`[ 1 ] [ 2 ] [ 3 ] [ 4 ] [ 5 ]`	_____	**Chapter 4**
Stage 03: Kickoff Gate *(48-Hr Client Onboarding)*	The delivery clock never starts until 100% of logins, brand files, and communication rules are signed off within 48 hours.	`[ 1 ] [ 2 ] [ 3 ] [ 4 ] [ 5 ]`	_____	**Chapter 5**
Stage 04: Delivery Gate *(Execute & Boundary Control)*	I execute via the 20/60/20 Sandwich Method and trigger a priced P.V.P. Change Order on 100% of out-of-scope requests.	`[ 1 ] [ 2 ] [ 3 ] [ 4 ] [ 5 ]`	_____	**Chapters 6, 7 & 8**
Stage 05: Expansion Gate *(Offboard & Retainer Bridge)*	Every project ends with a clean SOP handover vault, an ROI case-study interview, and a 90-day retainer proposal.	`[ 1 ] [ 2 ] [ 3 ] [ 4 ] [ 5 ]`	_____	**Chapters 9 & 10**
OVERALL SCORE	**Total Lifecycle Gate Integrity (`Max: 25`)**	`_____ / 25`	**Single Lowest-Scoring Gate:** _____	**Start Here Next**

Part C: Daily 3-Block Priority Planner (5-Day Execution Template)

Use **Prompt 1.3** every afternoon at 4:45 PM (or 8:15 AM) to lock your three protected daily blocks before opening your inbox:

Workday	Block 1: 90-Min Maker Block *(08:30–10:00 • Zero Inbox/Slack • Single Bucket A Deliverable)*	Block 2: 30-Min AI Admin Sprint *(11:30–12:00 • Batch Triage & Prompt 1.4 Replies)*	Block 3: 90-Min Delivery & Pipeline *(13:30–15:00 • 60m Craft + 30m Proposals)*	Block 1 Protected? (`Y/N`)
Monday	**Client / Milestone:** _____ **DoD:** _____	**Top 3 Replies / Change Orders:** `1.` _____ `2.` _____	**Delivery:** _____ **Pipeline:** _____	`[ Y / N ]`

Workday	Block 1: 90-Min Maker Block *(08:30–10:00 • Zero Inbox/Slack • Single Bucket A Deliverable)*	Block 2: 30-Min AI Admin Sprint *(11:30–12:00 • Batch Triage & Prompt 1.4 Replies)*	Block 3: 90-Min Delivery & Pipeline *(13:30–15:00 • 60m Craft + 30m Proposals)*	Block 1 Protected? (`Y/N`)
Tuesday	**Client / Milestone:** _____ **DoD:** _____	**Top 3 Replies / Change Orders:** 1. _____ 2. _____	**Delivery:** _____ **Pipeline:** _____	`[ Y / N ]`
Wednesday	**Client / Milestone:** _____ **DoD:** _____	**Top 3 Replies / Change Orders:** 1. _____ 2. _____	**Delivery:** _____ **Pipeline:** _____	`[ Y / N ]`
Thursday	**Client / Milestone:** _____ **DoD:** _____	**Top 3 Replies / Change Orders:** 1. _____ 2. _____	**Delivery:** _____ **Pipeline:** _____	`[ Y / N ]`
Friday	**Client / Milestone:** _____ **DoD:** _____	**Top 3 Replies / Change Orders:** 1. _____ 2. _____	**13:30–14:45 Delivery** + **15:00 Friday CEO Retro (Part D)**	`[ Y / N ]`

Part D: Friday 15-Minute CEO Retro (Weekly Bottleneck & Margin Review)

Complete every Friday at 3:00 PM alongside **Prompt 1.5** (*Friday 15-Minute Bottleneck Retrospective Synthesizer*) and **Prompt 1.2** (*Service Delivery SOP Extractor*):

1. **Weekly EHR & Utilization Check:** * **Gross Revenue Billed + Change Orders Captured This Week:** `$_____` * **Total Real Working Hours Logged (`Buckets A + B + C + D`):** `_____ hrs` * **This Week's Actual Effective Hourly Rate (`EHR`):** `$_____ / hr` *(Variance vs. Baseline Line F: `+$_____ / hr`)*
2. **Scope Circuit-Breaker Audit (Gate 1 + Prompt 1.4):** * **Out-of-Scope Client Requests Received This Week:** `____` * **Converted to Paid Change Orders:** `____` *(Total Extra Revenue Captured: `+$_____`)* * **Deferred / Dropped by Client Without Unpaid Work:** `____` * **Slipped Through as Unpaid Work (`Target: 0`):** `____`
3. **Top Recurring Operational Bottleneck This Week:** * *Describe the single task, client misunderstanding, or admin delay that wasted the most time this week:*
   _____
4. **20-Minute System Fix / New SOP Extracted (via Prompt 1.2):** * *Name of checklist, template, or boundary clause created today so this bottleneck never repeats:*
   _____

Part E: Chapter 1 Sign-Off Checklist

Verify that all five foundational installation steps are complete before moving to **Chapter 2 (*Positioning & Productized Service Packaging*)**:

- ☐ **1. Baseline EHR Locked:** I have completed 7 days of Bucket A/B/C/D tracking in **Part A**, run **Prompt 1.1**, and recorded my exact baseline Effective Hourly Rate (`Line F` : `$_____/hr`).
- ☐ **2. Lifecycle Bottleneck Identified:** I have scored all five gates in **Part B** (`Total Score: ____/25`) and identified my single weakest lifecycle gate.
- ☐ **3. Daily 3-Block Calendar Installed:** My calendar has recurring holds for **Block 1 (90-Min Maker Block)**, **Block 2 (30-Min AI Admin Sprint)**, and **Block 3 (90-Min Delivery & Pipeline Block)**.
- ☐ **4. Boundary Reply Tested:** I have customized **Prompt 1.4** with my current project scope variables and saved the output template for immediate use during midday triage sprints.
- ☐ **5. First SOP Extracted:** I have run **Prompt 1.2** on at least one repetitive client workflow and saved the resulting 1-page checklist in my operations folder.

Practitioner Sign-Off Date: `____ / ____ / 2026` • **Ready for Chapter 2:** `[ YES ]`